Emergency Preparedness Policy

Policy Summary & Knowledge Check

Authority	Board of Directors
Date Ratified	November 21, 2023
Next Review Date	November 2026
Previous Amendments	February 26, 2016; October 30, 2012; November 15, 2011

Policy Summary

This policy reflects the USC's commitment to the health, safety, and welfare of persons and the protection of property should an emergency occur. It applies to all USC employees and defines reporting contacts for different hazard types (fire, weather, flooding, safety concerns, violence, medical emergencies, and other incidents), assigns responsibilities to the USC, the USC Emergency Response Representative, acting supervisors, and managers, and summarizes basic Western procedures for fire/evacuation and situations of immediate danger.

Key Takeaways

- Applies to all USC employees; an "emergency" is an urgent or critical situation, temporary in nature, that threatens or causes harm to people, the environment, property, or disrupts critical operations.
- Different emergency types have specific reporting contacts: Fire (ext. 83300), Weather/Flooding/Power failure (ext. 83304), Safety concerns (ext. 80371), and Violence, Medical emergencies, gas leaks, chemical spills, and most other emergencies (911 - Western Campus Police).
- The USC must observe Western's emergency-related policies, declare an emergency or close operations if Western does so, collaborate with Western's Emergency Response Team, and display emergency numbers by all USC telephones.
- The USC Emergency Response Representative (a member of senior management) can declare an emergency and close operations, collaborates with Western's Emergency Response Team/Committee, maintains USC emergency policies and training materials annually, coordinates departmental continuity plans, and maintains a secure list of emergency contacts.
- Acting supervisors assist the Emergency Response Representative and ensure the safety of their workers and work areas; managers train employees on operation-specific emergency and evacuation plans as part of job-specific orientation.
- In case of fire/evacuation: raise the alarm from a safe area while evacuating, use stairwells, close doors and windows, and remain outside until authorized to re-enter by the Fire Department, Western Police, or Western's Emergency Response Team.
- In situations of immediate danger: avoid escalating the situation, leave an unsafe area, or if safe evacuation isn't possible, seek shelter, lock doors, avoid windows, and call Campus Police at 911.
- Only personnel trained and acting within their competency may transport ill or injured persons requiring emergency medical transportation.

Knowledge Check

5 situational questions to check understanding of this policy. An answer key follows on the next page.

Q1. A fire breaks out in a USC office. What is the correct first action per the procedures referenced in this policy?

A. Use the elevator to leave the building quickly.
B. Wait for a building-wide announcement before moving.
C. Call ext. 83304 before doing anything else.
D. Raise the alarm from a safe area on the way to evacuate, then use stairwells.

Q2. An employee needs to report a suspected gas leak. Which number should they call?

A. 911 - Western Campus Police.

B. Ext. 83300.

C. Ext. 83304.

D. Ext. 80371.

Q3. Who has the authority within the USC to declare an emergency and close regular operations?

A. Any employee who feels unsafe.

B. The USC Emergency Response Representative.

C. The Health & Safety Coordinator only.

D. Western Campus Police exclusively.

Q4. An employee cannot safely evacuate during a situation of immediate danger. What should they do?

A. Exit through a window if on a low floor.

B. Attempt to move through the danger to reach the nearest stairwell.

C. Seek shelter where they are, lock doors, avoid windows, and call Campus Police at 911.

D. Wait by the elevator for rescue.

Q5. A visitor becomes seriously injured and requires emergency transport to a medical facility. Who is permitted to provide this transport?

A. The visitor's own emergency contact.

B. Any campus security staff, regardless of medical training.

C. Any nearby employee with a vehicle.

D. Only personnel trained and acting within their competency.

Answer Key

Q1: D — Section 4.1.1 directs raising the alarm from a safe area on the way to evacuate the building and using stairwells to evacuate.

Q2: A — Section 3.1.2.7 lists gas leaks (among other emergencies) as reportable to 911 - Western Campus Police.

Q3: B — Section 3.2.1 states the USC Emergency Response Representative has authority within the USC to declare an emergency and close regular operations.

Q4: C — Section 4.2.3 directs seeking shelter where you are if safe evacuation is not possible, locking doors, avoiding windows, and calling Campus Police at 911.

Q5: D — Section 4.3 states persons requiring emergency transportation to a medical facility must be transferred by trained personnel acting within their competency.